

Counselor Coordination Protocol

The Hackles Kit

A free kit by Competence Collective · competencecollective.org · quillsup.org · October 2026

© 2026 Competence Collective. Lesson text and teaching materials CC BY-NC 4.0. The Hackles name, logos, characters and artwork are not covered by that license: print and share them unaltered for classroom and family use; any other use needs written permission. [VERIFY with counsel]

Status: DRAFT for local review, 2026-10-05. Not legal advice. Hackles has not been reviewed, approved or endorsed by FLDOE or any state agency. It has not been evaluated in a controlled study. Every legal or statistical statement is marked [VERIFY] or [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]; ask your own counsel before relying on it.

How an administrator, a teacher and a school counselor (or librarian, youth worker or college advisor in other settings) coordinate around Hackles. It builds on the kit's Counselor Heads-Up and Opt-Out Toolkit and the Disclosure and Incident Guide. Fit it to your policy, your state's rules and the roles in your building.
[COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]

01 Purpose and principles

- A counselor knows which lessons are coming and is ready for students and teachers afterward.
- Families hear about sensitive lessons first from the school, in plain words, with a real choice.
- A disclosure leads to help for the child and a report as the law requires. It never leads to blame.
- Nobody is penalized for opting out.
- Everyone records counts only. Case notes live in the school's confidential files, not in the tracker.

02 Roles

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY
Administrator	Approves schedule and letters. Confirms reporting routes. Designates who secures devices. Gives the counselor time. Reports counts to the board
Hackles lead (teacher, librarian or counselor)	Keeps the calendar. Sends reminders. Collects counts. Fixes errors
Counselor	Reviews sensitive lessons. Is on call on lesson days. Meets students who ask or need it. Leads the alternate activity. Debriefs teachers
Teacher	Teaches. Gives the heads-up. Sends family notices. Follows the disclosure steps. Records counts
Library or youth leader (non-school settings)	Same as teacher. Names the person who plays the counselor role

03 Which lessons are sensitive

FROM THE COUNSELOR TOOLKIT (confirm against your edition and scope).

BAND	LESSON	WHY IT IS SENSITIVE
K-2	6 Online Friends vs. Real Friends	Secrets and unsafe contact
K-2	9 My Body Is Mine	Body safety
3-5	1 The Help Ladder	Role-play of telling about worries
3-5	6 Game Chat Red Flags	Grooming warning signs, secrecy, pressure
6-8	1 Help Ladder: Real Practice	Disclosure rehearsal
6-8	6 Grooming Patterns; 7 Pressure Online; 8 Fakes That Hurt	Grooming, sextortion, deepfakes
9-12	5 Sextortion and Image Abuse; 7 Coercion in Relationships Online; 8 Be the Helper	Sextortion, control, self-harm
6-8 and 9-12	Plus P1 (trafficking), Plus P2 (mental health)	Specialist or clinician review required before use

Recommended heads-up only: 6-8 Plus P3; 9-12 Plus P3 and P4. Also give a heads-up whenever a known rumor or bullying incident touches the class.

04 Timeline for each sensitive lesson

WHEN	WHO	WHAT
3 weeks before	Administrator, counselor	Confirm which lessons count as sensitive, check notice and opt-out policy, confirm counselor availability
3 weeks before	Counselor	Review the lesson text
2 weeks before	Teacher	Send the family pre-notice (Parent Letter Set, Letter 2)
1 week before	Teacher, counselor	Offer family preview. Collect slips. Arrange alternate activities
2 days before	Teacher	Send the counselor heads-up message. Confirm coverage and how to reach the counselor during the lesson
Day of	Counselor	On call. Quiet space ready. Drop-in available
Day of	Teacher	Calm opening and closing scripts. Offer the "ask the counselor" option
24 hours after	Teacher, counselor	Debrief. Check in with any upset student. Process any disclosure per the flowchart
1 week after	Teacher	Take-home card and optional reply slip
1 month after	Counselor	Re-check on students who needed support. Add counts to the tracker

05 Heads-up message (teacher to counselor)

FIELD NOTE	No. 1
Subject: Heads-up: sensitive lesson on [date, period] Hello [name], I will teach "[lesson title]" to [class/group] on [date]. It covers [one plain sentence]. It is not graphic. Could you: be available (or arrange backup) from [time] to [time]; tell me the best way to reach you during the lesson; tell me, privately and without sharing details with me, whether any students should have a check-in before or after; and tell me if you would like to co-teach the last five minutes? Family notice goes out on [date]. Opt-out slips so far: [count]. If a student discloses, I will follow the First 10 Minutes steps and bring you in the same day. Thank you. [name]	

06 Opt-outs and alternates

1. Receive the family's choice in writing. Acknowledge it warmly the same day.
2. Offer a preview first. Many families choose to take part after seeing the materials.
3. Offer a respectful alternate that does not label the child: a quiet library or reading task, a general kindness or screen-balance activity from the same strand, a counselor-led small group on trusted adults, or the family-led version with the take-home card.

4. For Plus P1 and P2, use the listed alternates (6-8 "Job Scams" and "My Limits"; 9-12 "Spot the Scam" and the Two-Week Experiment) and make sure each alternate still hands over the reporting or help card.
5. Make sure the child knows the core help message in the family's own words: "If anything ever worries you, tell a grown-up you trust. You are never in trouble."
6. Record the opt-out in the confidential file. The tracker takes the count only.
7. Review each year. Families may change their minds at any time.

NEVER SAY: "YOUR CHILD will be left out," "You are keeping them unsafe," or "Everyone else is doing it."

07 When a student discloses

1. The teacher or any adult who hears it follows the First 10 Minutes steps (see the Crisis and Disclosure Flowchart) and the Disclosure and Incident Guide.
2. The adult reports personally under law and policy, then tells the administrator and counselor. [Local fill]
3. The counselor supports the student. The counselor does not investigate and does not promise secrecy.
4. The administrator decides, with counsel and the reporting authority, how and when families are told, keeping the child's safety first.
5. If a family member may be involved, or the student fears for their safety, do not contact the family first. Follow the advice of the child-protection or law-enforcement contact.
6. If images are involved, nobody views, copies, forwards or screenshots them. The device is secured as policy directs.
7. If a student is at risk of self-harm, stay with them, follow the crisis protocol, and use 988 as appropriate. [VERIFIED 2026-10-05 in the kit's guides: 988lifeline.org]
8. The counselor checks on the teacher the same day.

08 Counselor checklist for a sensitive-lesson day

- ☐ I know which classes have the lesson and when.
- ☐ I am free, or have coverage, during and after each lesson.
- ☐ A quiet private space is ready.
- ☐ I have the list of opt-outs and each alternate arrangement.
- ☐ I have a confidential list of students who may need a check-in before the lesson.

- ☐ I have blank Disclosure and Incident Records and know our reporting steps. [local fill]
- ☐ I know who the administrator on call is.
- ☐ I have resource information ready: 988, Crisis Text Line, the NCMEC CyberTipline, Take It Down, our state child-abuse line [local fill] and, where relevant, human trafficking hotlines. [VERIFY all numbers before printing]
- ☐ For Plus P1 and P2 I have confirmed that the review is done.

09 Counts the counselor reports (no names)

NUMBER OF SENSITIVE LESSONS delivered, number of students who asked to talk, number of referrals, number of reports made as required (only if policy permits sharing), themes and needs. These go to the administrator and, as tallies, into the tracker's "Support and safety" columns. A rising number of disclosures after a lesson is expected and is not a sign of failure.

10 Limits

THIS PROTOCOL IS GUIDANCE, not legal advice. Reporting duties differ by state, district and school type. The kit's guides have not had a human counselor or child-safety review as of 2026-10-05. Ask your own counselor and counsel to review before use. [COUNSEL TO CONFIRM]